RAHEL KESSETE AFEWERKY
Western Michigan University, Department of Political Science
rahelkessete.afewerky@wmich.edu/rahelkessete@gmail.com

## EDUCATION

Ph.D., Political Science *Expected* Spring 2027
Western Michigan University, Kalamazoo, MI, USA
Fields: Comparative Politics, International Relations, and Political Theory
Dissertation Title: Silenced to Compliance: The Absence of Popular Protests in Authoritarian Eritrea (1998-2023)
Committee: Dr. Emily Hauptmann (Chair); Dr. Yuan-Kang Wang; Dr. David Siegel (Duke University)
Award: WMU Dissertation Completion Fellowship (2026-2027)

M.A., Political Science
Western Michigan University, Kalamazoo, MI, USA

M.A., International Relations
Marmara University, Istanbul, Turkey

B.A., Political Science and International Relations
Adi Keih College of Arts and Social Sciences, Eritrea

## PUBLICATIONS (Selected)

### Peer-Reviewed Publications:

- Afewerky, R. K. (2023). Residual Responsibility to Implement: the AU, the Constitutive Act, and the Responsibility to Protect. *Global Responsibility to Protect*, 16(2), 127-149

- Afewerky, R. K. (2022). Darfur: R2P and Dilemmas of Implementation. In *The Responsibility to Protect Twenty Years On: Rhetoric and Implementation*, Cham: Springer International Publishing. 33-53

### Working Papers:

- Why Protest? The Anatomy of "Genuine" Popular Protests and Their Role in Ushering in Democratic Change (Best Paper Award, 56th MIPSA Conference)

- The Controversy Behind The Istanbul Convention: The Role of Ruling Parties in the Fight to End Violence Against Women and Domestic Violence in Poland and Turkey

- Writing on and about Authoritarian Regimes: The Case of Eritrea

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE (Selected)

**As Instructor**

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|---|---|
| Modern Political Thought | Fall 25 |
| International Relations | Summer I 23, Spring 24, Summer I 24, Fall 24, Summer II 25, Spring 26 |

**As a Teaching Assistant:**

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|---|---|
| Data in Politics and Policy | Spring 25 |
| Public Policy and the Economy | Spring 25 |
| Modern Political Thought | Fall 23 |
| International Relations | Spring 23 |
| Comparative Politics | Fall 22 |
| Women and Politics | Spring 22 |
| Environmental Politics | Fall 21 |

## HONORS AND AWARDS (Selected)

**Internal (WMU)**

- WMU Dissertation Completion Fellowship (2026-2027)
- College of Arts & Sciences Summer Graduate Research Development Grant (2025 & 26)
- Department Graduate Teaching Effectiveness Award, WMU (2026)
- Graduate Student Research Grant, WMU (Spring 2026)
- Graduate Student Travel Grant, WMU (Fall 2025)
- Department Travel Grant (Spring 2022, Spring 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2025, Fall 2026)
- All-University Graduate Research and Creative Scholar Award, WMU (2024)
- Howard Wolpe Scholarship Award in Political Science (2024, 2025, and 2026)
- Department Graduate Research and Creative Scholar Award, WMU (2023)
- Robert Kleiner Memorial Scholarship sponsored by WMU-AAUP (2022)
- John R. Borsos Memorial Endowed Scholarship, WMU (2021 and 2022)

**External**

- 122nd American Political Science Association Annual Conference Travel Grant (2026)
- 66th Annual International Studies Association Convention Travel Grant (2025)
- Best Paper Award, 56th Annual Michigan Political Science Association Conference (2024)
- Empirical Implications of Theoretical Models Certification (2024)
- Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research (ICPSR) Summer Program Scholarship (Fully Funded, Summer 2024)
- Erasmus Mundus Internship Grant, Tactics Institute for Security and Counter-Terrorism, London, UK (Summer 21)
- Erasmus Mundus Exchange Scholarship, Sapienza University of Rome, Italy (Spring 21)
- Turkish Government Scholarship (Türkiye Bursları) (2016-2021)
- Medal of Honors (Very Great Distinction), Adi Keih College of Arts and Social Sciences, Adi Keih, Eritrea

## RESEARCH AND TEACHING WORKSHOP/TRAINING (Selected)

- Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research (ICPSR), University of Michigan (Summer 2024)
- Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research (IQMR), Syracuse University (Summer 2023)
- WMUx Professional Development Series Training by WMUx Office of Faculty Development and Instructional Design, WMU (Summer 2022 and 2024)

## PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- American Political Science Association
- International Studies Association
- Midwest Political Science Association
- Visions In Methodology
- Michigan Political Science Association
- Pi Sigma Alpha, the National Political Science Honor Society

## CONFERENCE & WORKSHOP PRESENTATIONS (Selected)

- American Political Science Association Conference 2026
- International Studies Association 2025, 2026
- Michigan Political Science Association Conference 2024
- Midwest Political Science Conference 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025
- Responsibility to Protect in Theory and Practice Conference 20 Years, UK 2021

## SKILLS

- Programming Languages: R, Python, Excel, and LATEX
- Languages: Tigrinya (Native Speaker), Turkish (Fluent); French (Beginner)

## SERVICE TO THE COMMUNITY (Selected)

- Office of Faculty Development, WMU: Panelist, Graduate Teaching Assistant Training session, 2026
- Women of Color in Political Science Biennial Pre-Conference (held at the American Political Science Association Annual Meeting): Organizing Team Member (team led by Dr. Sharon Austin, University of Florida) and Moderator, 2026
- International Studies Association, 67th Annual Convention: Volunteer, On-Site, 2026
- ICPSR Summer Program, University of Michigan: Opportunity Scholar Mentor, 2025
- Midwest Political Science Association, Annual Conference: Discussant, 2022
- WMU: International Student Orientation Leadership Program, Spring and Summer 2022

## REFERENCES

**Dr. Emily Hauptmann**
Professor, Department of Political Science
Western Michigan University
emily.hauptmann@wmich.edu
(269) 387-5695

**Dr. David Siegel**
Professor, Department of Political Science and Pu
Duke University
david.siegel@duke.edu
(919) 660-4300

**Dr. Kevin Corder**
Professor, Department of Political Science
Western Michigan University
j.kevin.corder@wmich.edu
(269) 387-5697

**Dr. Yuan-Kang Wang**
Professor, Department of Political Science
Western Michigan University
yuan-kang.wang@wmich.edu
(269) 387-5701